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Pneumatic motor

Abstract

A pneumatic motor for rotating an axle including: a. a housing including: b. an air intake port; c. an air exhaust port; d. at least two cylinders; each cylinder being positioned radially from the axle; e. at least two air channels in communication with each cylinder; f. at least two pistons, each piston attached to the axle by a connecting rod, each piston and respective connecting rod being radially aligned, each piston to be received in one of said at least two cylinders; each connecting rod being attached centrally offset in relation to a central axis of the axle; wherein when one connecting rod and piston are in power stroke, the other connecting rod and piston are in exhaust stroke.

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Background/Summary

FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

(1) This disclosure relates to a pneumatic motor with improvements thereto including multiple stacked radial pistons, unitary cylinder cap, a modular valve bushing and a controller for regulating air speed, air supply, motor speed and reading of speed and air supply and torque, depending on load.

BACKGROUND

(2) Current pneumatic motors (or air motors) include pistons aligned in the same plane. It has been found that pneumatic motors with pistons in the same plane result in the requirement of thrust washers and retainers to allow rotation without interference. Furthermore, current pneumatic motors include valve bushings that are unitary. It has been found that unitary valve bushings result in galling and seizing of the pneumatic motor due to the entry of unwanted particles via the air source into the motor. Furthermore, current pneumatic motors include cylinder covers that are multi-component. It has been found that multi-component cylinder covers result in the build-up of unwanted heat in the motors as well as air loss, reducing the efficiency of the pneumatic motor. Furthermore, current pneumatic motors lack a controller to regulate air speed, motor speed, air supply to the motor as well as reading and transmission of data associated with the pneumatic motor. There is a need for a pneumatic motor with pistons being in different parallel planes. There is also a need for a pneumatic motor with modular valve bushings. There is also a need for a pneumatic motor with a unitary cylinder cap. There is also a need for a pneumatic motor controller.

SUMMARY

(3) According to one aspect, there is provided: a pneumatic motor for rotating an axle comprising: a housing comprising an air intake port; an air exhaust port; at least two cylinders; wherein each cylinder is positioned radially from the axle; in one alternative, each cylinder being in a distinct radial plane from each other; at least two air channels in communication with each cylinder; at least two pistons, each piston attached to the axle by a connecting rod, each piston and respective connecting rod being radially aligned, in respect of the axle and in one alternative, in a distinct radial plane from each other, each piston to be received in one of said at least two cylinders; each connecting rod being attached centrally offset in relation to a central axis of said axle;

(4) According to another aspect, there is provided a modular bushing fit onto said axle to regulate communication of said air intake port and said air exhaust port with said at least two air channels in communication with each cylinder; wherein during a power stroke of one piston or more, said axle allows said air intake port to be in communication with the air channel in communication with said one cylinder allowing air from the air intake port to enter into the cylinder; and during an exhaust stroke of one piston or more, said axle allows said air exhaust port to be in communication with the air channel in communication with said one cylinder allowing air to exit the cylinder through the air exhaust port; wherein, when one connecting rod and piston are in power stroke, the other connecting rod and piston are in exhaust stroke.

(5) In another alternative, one end of each of said connecting rods are stacked one atop another on said axle, in an axially offset configuration, resulting in each of said connecting rods and each of said pistons connected to said respective connecting rod being in a distinct radial plane, each distinct radial plane being parallel to each other.

(6) In another alternative, each of said connecting rods is stacked one atop another and is separated one from another by a spacer on said axle.

(7) In another alternative, each of said connecting rods stacked one atop another further comprise a bearing on said axle between each of said connecting rods.

(8) In another alternative, said axle further comprises an air intake face and an air exhaust face.

(9) In another alternative, said air intake face and said air exhaust face run along a length of said axle and are opposite each other along the length of said axle.

(10) In another alternative, said pneumatic motor further comprises a modular valve bushing to fit

over said axle for allowing communication of air to/from the pneumatic motor, depending on the rotational location of said axle in relation to said modular valve bushing. The modular valve bushing described herein differs from the prior art bushing made of a single piece which has exhibited the following drawbacks including the inability to use a bearing material in the sealing area to eliminate the possibility of galling as well as the opportunity to provide minimal interference to reduce air consumption and leakage. In one alternative, said modular valve bushing comprises an upper component, a lower component and an intermediary component wherein the upper component and lower component are matingly engaged with each other by said intermediary component.

(11) In another alternative, said upper component, lower component and intermediary component are hollow cylinders, each having an outer diameter surface and at least one inner diameter surface.

(12) In another alternative, the outer diameter surface of said intermediary component matingly engages with the inner diameter of said upper component and lower component.

(13) In another alternative said upper component is a hollow cylinder having a top surface, a bottom surface, an outer collar surface and an inner collar surface. In yet another alternative, said upper component further comprises a plurality of air inlet and outlet channels. In one alternative, said air inlet and outlet channels run axially and radially to said hollow cylinder of said upper component. In one alternative, a portion of said channels run axially to said hollow cylinder of said upper component and are air exhaust channels.

(14) In another alternative, said lower component is a hollow cylinder having a top surface, a bottom surface, an outer collar surface and an inner collar surface. In yet another alternative, said lower component further comprises at least one air intake channel running axially to said hollow cylinder of said lower component. In one alternative, said at least one air intake channel running axially to said hollow cylinder of said lower component is situated at an upper portion of said lower component.

(15) In another alternative, said intermediary component is a connecting collar for connecting said upper component with said lower component. In one alternative, said connecting collar further comprises an inner diameter surface and an outer diameter surface.

(16) In another alternative, each of said upper component and lower component further comprise a connecting collar receiving section to each receive an end of said connecting collar top axially connecting the upper component with the lower component forming a cylinder valve bushing for a pneumatic motor. The lower component includes an upper area of a first diameter and a lower area of a second diameter. The second diameter being smaller than the first diameter allowing the connecting collar to be friction fitted within the upper and lower components, preferably causing said connecting collar to be non-rotating when connecting the upper and lower components.

(17) In another alternative, said connecting collar is locked to said modular bushing via a locking pin. In one alternative, said connecting collar is locked to said upper component via a locking pin.

(18) In another alternative, said air inlet channels of said upper component are in fluid communication with said at least one air intake channel of said lower component when said air intake face of said axle is in line with said at least one air intake channel of said lower component, during rotation of said axle.

(19) In another alternative, said air outlet channels of said upper component are in fluid communication with said air exhaust port when said air exhaust face of said axle is in line with said air outlet channels of said upper component, during rotation of said axle. It has been found that the modular bushing, due to the surface characteristics of the connecting collar being softer or less dense than the surface characteristics of the rotating axle prevents foreign or unwanted particulates, that may enter with the air supply to the pneumatic motor, to impact and compromise the surface of the axle by allowing any foreign particulates to be absorbed by the surface of the connecting collar thereby mitigating damage (including seizing of the motor due to a foreign particulate between the connecting collar (intermediary bushing) surface and axle surface) to pneumatic motor parts by

foreign particulate material entering the system with the air supply.

(20) According to yet another alternative, there is provided a unitary piston cylinder cap in a pneumatic motor, in one alternative at least two unitary piston cylinder caps in a pneumatic motor, each cylinder cap forming a cylinder, on said pneumatic motor, each cylinder for receiving each of said at least two pistons, eliminating the need for a cylinder sleeve and associated seals thereby reducing the number of parts and mitigating air leakage between a cylinder cap and a cylinder sleeve, the prior art combination cylinder cap and a cylinder sleeve forming a piston cylinder.

(21) In one alternative, said unitary piston cylinder cap further comprises an cylinder cap air channel for communication with said air channel in communication with said cylinder of said pneumatic motor housing for the exchange of air into and out of a space formed by a piston and a cylinder cap, in one alternative, each of said at least two unitary piston cylinder caps further comprise an cylinder cap air channel for communication with said air channel in communication with said cylinder of said pneumatic motor housing for the exchange of air into and out of a space formed by each of said at least two pistons and each of said at least two cylinder caps.

(22) According to yet another alternative, there is provided a pneumatic motor for rotating an axle comprising: a housing comprising an air intake port; an air exhaust port; at least three cylinders; wherein each cylinder is positioned radially from the axle; in one alternative, each cylinder being in a distinct radial plane from each other; at least two air channels in communication with each cylinder; at least three pistons, each piston attached to the axle by a connecting rod, each piston and respective connecting rod being radially aligned, and in one alternative, in a distinct radial plane from each other and each connecting rod being stacked in relation to each other, each piston to be received in one of said at least three cylinders; each connecting rod being attached centrally offset in relation to a central axis of said axle; a modular bushing fit onto said axle to regulate communication of said air intake port and said air exhaust port with said at least two air channels in communication with each cylinder; wherein during a power stroke of at least one piston, said axle allows said air intake port to be in communication with the air channel in communication with said one cylinder allowing air from the air intake port to enter into the cylinder; and during an exhaust stroke of at least one piston, said axle allows said air exhaust port to be in communication with the air channel in communication with said one cylinder allowing air to exit the cylinder through the air exhaust port; wherein when one connecting rod and piston are in power stroke, the other connecting rod and piston are in exhaust stroke and the third connecting rod and piston are in between an exhaust stroke and a power stroke.

(23) In one alternative, there is provided at least three unitary piston cylinder caps, each cylinder cap forming a cylinder, on said pneumatic motor, each cylinder for receiving each of said at least three pistons.

(24) In one alternative, each of said at least three unitary piston cylinder caps further comprise an cylinder cap air channel for communication with said air channel in communication with said cylinder of said pneumatic motor housing for the exchange of air into and out of a space formed by each of said at least three pistons and each of said at least three cylinder caps.

(25) In one alternative, each of said at least three unitary piston cylinder caps are in a distinct horizontal plane from each other.

(26) According to yet another alternative, there is provided a pneumatic motor for rotating an axle comprising: a housing comprising an air intake port; an air exhaust port; at least six cylinders; each cylinder being positioned radially from the axle; in one alternative each cylinder being in a distinct radial plane from each other; at least two air channels in communication with each cylinder; at least six pistons, each piston attached to the axle by a connecting rod, each piston and respective connecting rod being radially aligned, in respect of the axle and in one alternative, in a distinct radial plane from each other, each piston to be received in one of said at least six cylinders; each connecting rod being attached centrally offset in relation to a central axis of said axle; a modular bushing fit onto said axle to regulate communication of said air intake port and said air exhaust port

with said at least two air channels in communication with each cylinder; wherein during a power stroke of at least one piston, said axle allows said air intake port to be in communication with the air channel in communication with a cylinder of the piston during a power stroke allowing air from the air intake port to enter into the cylinder; and during an exhaust stroke of at least one piston, said axle allows said air exhaust port to be in communication with the air channel in communication with a cylinder of the piston undergoing an exhaust stroke allowing air to exit the cylinder through the air exhaust port.

(27) In one alternative, there is provided at least six unitary piston cylinder caps, each cylinder cap forming a cylinder, on said pneumatic motor, each cylinder for receiving each of said at least six pistons.

(28) In one alternative, each of said at least six unitary piston cylinder caps further comprise an cylinder cap air channel for communication with said air channel in communication with said cylinder of said pneumatic motor housing for the exchange of air into and out of a space formed by each of said at least six pistons and each of said at least six cylinder caps.

(29) In one alternative, there is provided a tachometer on said pneumatic motor to read rotations per minute of said axle.

(30) In yet another alternative, there is provided a controller, in communication with said tachometer, to regulate air pressure, air flow, air speed and motor speed and torque, depending on the load on said motor.

(31) It was found the intermediary component, in one alternative a collar, is resistant to heat expansion and contraction, and the coefficient of friction of the intermediary component, in one alternative a collar, surface is extremely low and further mitigates galling due to the surface of said intermediary component (in one alternative a collar) being of a material such that the surface absorbs any foreign particles thereby mitigating galling and seizing of said motor. A preferred material being Torlon™, polyvinylidene fluoride, glass filled Teflon™ and combinations thereof. Alternate materials are Teflon™, low density polyethylene, high density polyethylene, ultra high molecular weight (UHMW) Polyethylene, polypropylene, CE grade (canvas phenolic resin—general purpose grade) phenolic laminates, LE grade (cotton phenolic resin—electrical grade) phenolic laminates, nylon and combinations thereof.

(32) It was also determined that the modular bushing results in reduced air consumption (30% to 40%) by the pneumatic motor as compared to a unitary bushing, improving efficiency without compromising performance of the pneumatic motor. We also found the collar (intermediary component) allows for a reduced gap between the inside diameter of the collar against the outside diameter of the rotating shaft resulting in less leakage of air between the space formed by the outside diameter of the rotating shaft and the inside diameter of the collar.

(33) It was also found that the collar mitigates seizing of the shaft against the valve bushing.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

(1) FIG. 1A is a cross sectional view of a pneumatic motor with one cylinder undergoing an exhaust stroke, according to one alternative.

(2) FIG. 1B is a cross sectional view of a pneumatic motor with the cylinder of FIG. 1A undergoing a power stroke, according to one alternative.

(3) FIG. 2 is an exploded view of the pneumatic motor, as a three cylinder pneumatic motor, according to one alternative.

(4) FIG. 3A is an overhead cross-sectional view of the pneumatic motor showing pistons at various stages of power stroke and exhaust stroke, according to one alternative.

(5) FIG. 3B is an overhead cross-sectional view of the pneumatic motor showing pistons at various

stages of power stroke and exhaust stroke, according to one alternative.

(6) FIG. 3C is an overhead cross-sectional view of the pneumatic motor showing pistons at various stages of power stroke and exhaust stroke, according to one alternative.

(7) FIG. 4 is a cross-sectional view of the modular bushing, according to one alternative

(8) FIG. 5 is a cross-sectional view of the modular bushing, according to one alternative

(9) FIG. 5A is a perspective view of the modular bushing for a 3 cylinder pneumatic motor

(10) FIG. 5B is a perspective view of a modular bushing for a 6 cylinder pneumatic motor

(11) FIG. 6A is a cross-sectional view of a prior art cylinder sleeve and cap

(12) FIG. 6B is a cross-sectional view of a unitary cylinder cap, according to one alternative

(13) FIG. 7 is a cut-away view of the pneumatic motor according to one alternative

(14) FIG. 8 is an exploded view of the pneumatic motor, as a three cylinder pneumatic motor, according to one alternative

(15) FIG. 9 is an exploded view of the pneumatic motor, as a six cylinder pneumatic motor, according to one alternative

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

(16) Referring now to FIGS. 1A and 1B, there is depicted a cross-sectional view of the pneumatic motor **10**, according to one alternative, undergoing an exhaust stroke (FIG. 1A) and a power stroke (FIG. 1B). In this alternative, the pneumatic motor **10** has a motor housing **20** with an air intake port **30** and air exhaust port **40** each running normal to axle (or crankshaft) **50**. Axle **50** is rod shaped with step down reduction of diameter from a top end to a bottom end. Axle **50** has an air intake face **52** and an air exhaust face **54** along the length of the axle **50**. Air intake face **52** opposes air exhaust face **54**. Air intake face **52** and air exhaust face **54** each comprise a flat surface **56** indented into the axle **50** and running along a length of the axle **50** and each flat surface **56** terminating with end walls **59** running normal to the flat surface **56** and radially away from the longitudinal axis of the axle **50**. Each of said air intake face **52** and air exhaust face **54** forming a horizontal slot on said axle **50**. Said air intake face **52** is offset from said air exhaust face **54**, preferably longitudinally offset from said air exhaust face **54**. Cylinder cap **60** forms a cylinder for piston **70**. Each piston **70** is connected to axle **50** via piston connecting rod **80**. Piston connecting rod **80** is connected to said piston **70** via a wrist pin **82** allowing for a pendulum movement of said piston connecting rod **80** in relation to said piston **70** and a reciprocating movement of said piston **70** in relation to said cylinder formed by said cylinder cap **60**. As best seen in FIG. 1A, during the exhaust stroke of one piston **70** of the pneumatic motor **10**, piston **70** moves radially away from axle **50** and air exhaust face **54** is in line with air exhaust channel **57** (in the form of an annular ring) of lower bushing **90** resulting in air leaving through air exhaust port **40**. During the exhaust stroke, air intake port **30** is blocked to the cylinder since air intake face **52** is not in communication with air intake channel **58** (in the form of an annular ring) of upper bushing **100**.

(17) Referring now to FIG. 2, there is depicted an exploded view of the parts for an pneumatic motor **10** of FIGS. 1A and 1B having 3 cylinders, according to one alternative.

(18) Pneumatic motor **10** includes a vent **101** (which may also serve as a window to the interior of said motor and may be made of a transparent material) centrally located (although it may be offset from center of the motor head cover **103**) on an pneumatic motor head cover **103**, in this alternative, the pneumatic motor head cover **103** is triangular in shape and has three fastener holes **131** for three fasteners **102** to allow for fastening the pneumatic motor head cover **103** onto the top of motor housing **104**. Motor housing **104** includes three fastener holes **133** for alignment of pneumatic motor head cover **103** fastener holes **131**. Motor housing **104** is cylindrical in shape with three cylinder ports **134** (only one seen) each for receiving each of the three pistons **114**. Each cylinder port **134** is covered by a cylinder cap **60** (See FIG. 6B). Cylinder cap **60** is secured to the motor housing **104** by four cylinder cap fasteners **135**, in this alternative four screws, each of which fit in the cylinder cap fastener receivers **136** on each cylinder cap **60** and on the motor housing **104**. Cylinder cap **60** is sealed onto the motor housing **104** by a resilient seal **115**, in this alternative an

O-ring, used to form a seal at the end of the cylinder cap air channel **138** in the cylinder cap (see FIGS. **1A** and **1B**) between each of the cylinder caps **60** and each of motor housing cylinder air channel **139**. As best seen in FIG. **2** and FIG. **7**, in one alternative, each piston **114** and respective connecting rod **111** are stacked one atop the other offset the centre line of the axle **50** and secured onto the axle or crankshaft **117** with a crank pin **107**. Between the crank pin **107** and axle end of the connecting rod **111** is a bearing **108** and a spacer **109** to facilitate rotational movement of the crank pin **107** in relation to the axle end of the connecting rod **111**. Similarly, between each of the connecting rods is a bearing **108** and spacer **109** to facilitate rotational movement of the crank pin in relation to the axle end of the connecting rod **111** and to facilitate independent movement of each connecting rod in relation to each other. Around the circumferential wall of each piston **114** is a resilient seal **113** providing an air seal between the piston **114** and inside wall of the cylinder cap **60**. Piston **114** is connected to the end distant the axle **117** of connecting rod **111** by a wrist pin **112** as discussed above. Modular bushing comprised of upper bushing **121**, lower bushing **123**, connected to each other via intermediary bushing connector **122** and bushing O-ring **126**. Above the modular bushing is a bearing **118**, snap ring **119** and O-ring **120** serving as a seal between the modular bushing (upper bushing **121**, lower bushing **123**) and axle **117**. Below the modular bushing is a **124**, snap ring **125** and O-ring **120** serving as a seal between the modular bushing and axle **117**. Piston **114**, connecting rod **111** and wrist pin **112** make up a piston assembly **110**.

(19) Motor housing further includes an air supply connector **105** threaded to the air supply port **30** (See FIG. **1A**) and an air exhaust connector **106** threaded to the air exhaust port **40** (See FIG. **1A**).

(20) Referring now to FIG. **3A**, there is provided an overhead cross-sectional view of the pneumatic motor **10** and each piston **70** and different stages of power stroke and exhaust stroke of a 3-cylinder stacked piston pneumatic motor. Clearly depicted here is a stacked piston arrangement described above and the unitary cylinder cap **60** forming a cylinder for the piston **70**.

(21) Referring now to FIG. **3B**, there is provided a three-cylinder pneumatic motor with a non-stacked piston arrangement and a unitary cylinder cap, at various stages of power stroke and exhaust stroke.

(22) Referring now to FIG. **3C**, there is provided a six-cylinder pneumatic motor with a non-stacked piston arrangement and a unitary cylinder cap, at various stages of power stroke and exhaust stroke.

(23) Referring now to FIG. **4**, there is provided a cross sectional view and exploded view of one alternative of the modular bushing depicting the upper bushing **401**, lower bushing **405** and middle bushing **403**. Modular bushing is a cylinder with an outer diameter to snugly fit in the motor housing without any rotational movement and an inner diameter to snugly fit around the axle **50** to allow axle **50** to rotate. Upper bushing **401** includes an air port **406** running radially from the outer diameter wall to the inner diameter wall of the upper bushing **401**. The air port **406** serves to allow air to flow from the cylinder during an exhaust stroke. Upper bushing **401** further includes vertical channels, in this alternative three vertical channels **407** (only one depicted) for a 3 piston pneumatic motor, running lengthwise of the outer diameter wall of said bushing with an channel aperture (air port **406**) located near one end of each channel, in this alternative near the lower end of the bushing. The channel aperture running radially from the outer diameter wall to the inner diameter wall serving to allow the passage of compressed air for power and exhaust to the pistons. Lower bushing **405** includes an air port **408** running radially from the outer diameter wall to the inner diameter wall of the lower bushing serving to allow air to flow from the air supply (air intake) port **30** and the cylinder during a power stroke. Middle bushing **403** serves to keep the upper bushing **401** connected to the lower bushing **405** via a friction fit of the cylindrical middle bushing **403** between the upper and lower bushings. Middle bushing further includes air ports, that when connecting the upper and lower bushings, are inline with the upper bushing channel apertures by locking into the upper bushing with a lock pin (dowel (**402**)). Middle bushing **403** is further sealed onto lower bushing **405** by an O-ring seal **404**. Modular bushing includes a keyway **409** running

along the outside length of the modular bushing when assembled. The keyway **409** facilitates alignment of the modular bushing with the inside of the motor body by connecting with a key on said motor housing so the air passages on the motor body are inline with the air passages of the modular bushing, and also helps to keep the modular bushing in place in the motor body.

(24) Referring now to FIGS. **5**, **5A** and **5B** there is depicted a modular bushing, according to another alternative. In particular, FIG. **5** depicts a modular bushing having an upper bushing **501**, lower bushing **505**, connected to each other with a middle bushing **503**. Middle bushing **503** is sealed in place by an O-ring seal **504**, sealing the middle bushing **503** to the lower bushing **505**. In this alternative, middle bushing **503** includes an O-ring seal receiver **509**, in the shape of a ledge along one end of the middle bushing **503**. Middle bushing **503** includes radial apertures to align with air passage ways to cylinders found in the upper bushing **501**. In this alternative, modular bushing has an annular ring **506** on the inside diameter of upper bushing **501**. Annular ring **506** receives an O-ring (not depicted) providing a seal between the modular bushing and the shaft (or axle). In this alternative, lower bushing **505** includes an annular ring **507** on the inside of diameter of lower bushing **505**. Annular ring **507** receives an O-ring providing a seal between the lower bushing **505** and the shaft (or axle). Upper bushing **501** include an annular stop ring **508** to prevent the modular bushing from slipping down the shaft (or axle). Dowel **502** is shown via keyway **510** to keep middle bushing **503** secured in placed with upper bushing **501**. Keyway **510** aids in aligning the modular bushing in the pneumatic motor.

(25) FIG. **5A** provides an assembled modular bushing for a three-cylinder pneumatic motor.

(26) FIG. **5B** provides an assembled modular bushing for a six-cylinder pneumatic motor.

(27) Referring now to FIG. **6A**, there is depicted a PRIOR ART cylinder cap **601** and cylinder sleeve **603** arrangement with multiple components **602**, **604**.

(28) Referring now to FIG. **6B**, there is depicted a cross section of a unitary cylinder cap **605** (as seen in FIGS. **1A** and **1B**). FIG. **6B** shows that an O-ring and a cylinder sleeve have been eliminated with the unitary cylinder cap **605** and the air passage **138** in the unitary cylinder cap **605** is angled upwards from the motor body. The unitary cylinder cap reduces the number of part required to form a seal between the cylinder cap and motor body.

(29) Unitary cylinder cap **605** includes a motor body wall **607** to facilitate the seating of the cylinder cap **605** onto said motor body. Cylinder cap **605** includes an O-ring seal **606** to seal the air channel (**138/115**) against the motor body air channel **139**.

(30) Referring now to FIG. **7**, there is shown a cut-away view of FIGS. **1A**, **1B** and **2**, according to one alternative, depicting the stacked and staggered connecting rods **80** and pistons **70** secured radially offset said axle **50** by a crank pin **107**.

(31) Referring now to FIG. **8**, there is depicted an exploded view of a three-cylinder pneumatic motor and associated parts, according to one alternative. In particular, the pneumatic motor includes a vent **801** attached to a tachometer **803** which communicates with a controller **829**. Tachometer **803** provides information such as rotations per minute of the crankshaft **808**. Controller **829**, also provides rotations per minute of crankshaft **808** but also includes information such as air supply, airflow and may also allow for changing of air supply and air volume, air speed thus modifying the rotations per minute (motor speed). Tachometer **803** is secured onto the motor head **812** by three screws **802** fitting in apertures on motor **812**. Vent **801** also serves as a window to allow the user to see into the pneumatic motor. The top end of crankshaft **808** includes a grease fitting which secures a magnet **828** onto the crankpin **805**, which is inserted into crankshaft **808**. As crankshaft **808** makes a revolution, magnet **828** simultaneously makes a revolution, tachometer **803** will take a reading and then the reading will be calculated on a per minute basis and a readout on the tachometer will provide the rotations per minute. Between crankshaft **808** and crankpin **805** are a thrust washer **806** a needle bearing **807** and a second thrust washer **806**. Rod assembly **821** is prevented from moving vertically, by thrust washers **806** during the rotation of crankshaft **808** causing the rod assembly **821** to reciprocate in and out of cylinder formed by cylinder cap **815**.

Each unitary cylinder cap **815** is secured onto the motor head **812** by a series of four fasteners such as screws **802** and further sealed thereto by a cylinder seal **822**. Rod assembly **821** further includes a piston seal **820**. Crankshaft **808** sits within motor head **812** and in a three-piece modular bushing consisting of upper bushing **823** lower bushing **825** connected together via middle bushing **824**. Between middle bushing **824** and lower bushing **825** is O-ring **826** to further seal middle bushing **824** two lower bushing **825**. Around crankshaft **808** is bearing **809** and snap ring **810** to keep crankshaft **808** in place. Each upper air passage of upper bushing **823** is sealed with three O-rings **813** and sealed against the crankshaft **808** with a larger centrally located O-ring **827**. Motor body **814** is secured to motor head **812** via three cap screws **811**. Central collar **824** is sealed in place in lower bushing **825** with O-ring **826**. Crankshaft **808** is further sealed near the bottom thereof with crank seal **816**, held in place with snap ring **817** and further includes lower bearing **818** and snap ring **819**.

(32) Referring now to FIG. 9, there is depicted an exploded view of a six-cylinder pneumatic motor and associated parts, according to one alternative with all parts listed thereon being the same as those of FIG. 8 except there are six-cylinders rather than three-cylinders.

(33) The following is an example comparing a pneumatic motor using a prior art unitary bushing versus a modular bushing.

(34) Two pneumatic motors, one with a modular bushing and unitary cylinder caps described herein and one with a one piece prior art bushing were run under the same conditions and air consumption was measured. Pressure was regulated at various levels, rotations per minute (RPM) was kept constant at 100 and maximum torque (in-lb) and air consumption at cubic feet per minute (CFM) was measured.

(35) 3 Cylinder Motor with a Modular Bushing and Unitary Cylinder Caps

(36) SUPPLY PRESSURE: 120 P.S.I. (pounds per square inch). These values represent an average of 10-3 cylinder pneumatic motors assembled with a modular 3 piece bushing.

(37) TABLE-US-00001 P.S.I. CFM RPM MAX TORQUE 20 0.61 100 1.4 25 0.81 100 2.13 30 0.95 100 2.79 35 1.09 100 3.47 40 1.22 100 4.13 45 1.36 100 4.78 50 1.51 100 5.61 55 1.66 100 6.36 60 1.81 100 7.02 65 1.94 100 7.74 70 2.11 100 8.5 75 2.27 100 9.12 80 2.41 100 9.95 85 2.54 100 10.57 90 2.72 100 11.33 90 1.21 0 - stall 12.03

Prio Art 3 Cylinder Motor with a Unitary Bushing and Multicomponent Cylinder Caps

(38) SUPPLY PRESSURE: 120 P.S.I.

(39) These values represent an average of 3-3 cylinder pneumatic motors assembled with a 1 pc bushing.

(40) TABLE-US-00002 P.S.I. CFM RPM MAX TORQUE 20 1.06 100 0.79 25 1.27 100 1.51 30 1.48 100 2.17 35 1.73 100 2.83 40 1.94 100 3.48 45 2.21 100 4.36 50 2.47 100 5.04 55 2.67 100 5.61 60 2.91 100 6.34 65 3.18 100 6.97 70 3.48 100 7.72 75 3.73 100 8.57 80 3.95 100 9.2 85 4.21 100 9.98 90 4.55 100 11.12 90 2.91 0 - stall 13.05

(41) As can be seen, unexpectedly the air consumption of the same pneumatic motor with a modular bushing used substantially less air in CFM while maintaining the same RPM and very close maximum torque when compared to a unitary bushing.

(42) The following is a calculation of return on investment with a 6 cylinder pneumatic motor described herein having a modular bushing. 1 horsepower (HP) is equal to 746 watts (W) or 0.746 KW ($\frac{3}{4}$ KW)

(43) On average most compressors will produce 4 CFM @ 90 PSI per 1 HP Therefore: @ 90 PSI it takes 0.746 KW ($\frac{3}{4}$ KW) to produce 4 CFM. 0.746 KW divided by 4 CFM=0.1865 KW for 1 CFM.

(44) Therefore, it takes 0.1865 KW to produce 1 CFM.

(45) Calculation of Cost Savings

(46) Step 1. Calculate the CFM difference with pneumatic motor described herein and a prior art motor using a simple CFM gauge.

(47) Example: Prior art 3 cylinder pneumatic motor: 4.55 CFM pneumatic motor

(48) 3 cylinder pneumatic motor (with 3 pc. Bushing): 2.72 CFM. Difference in CFM usage=1.83 CFM.

(49) Step 2. Calculate local electrical supply costs.

(50) For this example we will use \$0.10 per kwh (it cost \$0.10 to create 1 KW for 1 hour).

(51) Step 3. Take what is known: 0.1865 kw/CFM and multiply it by hrs/day (24) and days/year

(365) $0.1865 \times 24 \times 365 = 1,633.74$ KW

(52) Conclusion: It takes 1,633.74 KW to create one CFM for 24 hrs a day for 1 year.

(53) Step 4. Multiply your kw/year value (1,633.74) by your local electricity supply costs (\$0.10/kwh)

$1,633.74 \times \$0.10 = \163.37

(54) Conclusion: It takes \$163.37 to create 1 CFM 24 hrs a day for 1 year.

(55) Step 5. Multiply the cost to create 1 CFM/year (\$163.37) by the total difference in CFM (1.83)

$\$163.37 \times 5.48 = \298.96

(56) Conclusion: The total savings (in compressed air alone) over 1 year when using the pneumatic motor described herein compared to a prior art motor with a unitary bushing is \$298.96 per pneumatic motor.

(57) The following provides the difference in operating temperature comparing a prior art pneumatic motor with the pneumatic motor described herein.

(58) Temperature readings were taken near the cylinder cap from a three cylinder pneumatic motor after one hour of run time at ambient room temperature of 65 degrees F.

(59) Pneumatic motors were each ran at 200 RPM

(60) TABLE-US-00003 UNITARY CYLINDER CAP PRIOR ART 2 PC. CAP AND SLEEVE 66 deg. 82 deg. 68 deg. 81 deg. 66 deg. 83 deg. 69 deg. 82 deg. 68 deg. 84 deg.

(61) There is a significant decrease in temperature (16-20% lower) during run time when a unitary cylinder cap is used versus the prior art multi-piece cylinder cap

(62) Pneumatic motors were each ran at 800 RPM

(63) TABLE-US-00004 UNITARY CYLINDER CAP PRIOR ART 2 PC. CAP AND SLEEVE 74 deg. 94 deg. 70 deg. 98 deg. 76 deg. 101 deg. 77 deg. 97 deg. 75 deg. 98 deg.

(64) There is a significant decrease in temperature (21-29% lower) during run time when a unitary cylinder cap is used versus the prior art multi-piece cylinder cap.

(65) In terms of construction material: the motor housing may be made of aluminum, zinc, steel, cast iron, stainless steel, nylon, and combinations thereof; the vent may be made of nylon, acetal, glass filled nylon, low density polyethylene, and combinations thereof; the head cover may be made of aluminum, zinc, steel, cast iron, stainless steel, nylon, and combinations thereof; the crank pin may be made of steel, stainless steel, 4140 alloy steel and combinations thereof; the spacer may be made of steel, stainless steel, nylon, fiber and combinations thereof; the bearings may be made of steel, stainless steel and combinations thereof; the piston head may be made of glass filled nylon, acetal and combinations thereof; the connecting rod may be made of steel, brass, aluminum, Delrin, nylon, glass filled nylon, aluminum filled nylon and combinations thereof; the wrist pin may be made of steel, stainless, brass, bronze and combinations thereof; the piston seal may be made of urethane, Buna-N—O-rings, fluoroelastomer, Teflon, UHMW polyethylene and combinations thereof; the cylinder cap O-ring may be made of Buna, Fluoroelastomer, ethylene propylene diene terpolymer (EPDM rubber), Teflon™, fluorinated ethylene propylene (FEP) sold by DuPont, TFE/P rubber (Aflas™ by DuPont), perfluoro elastomer (Kalrez™ by DuPont USA) and combinations thereof; the crankshaft (axle) may be made of steel, stainless Steel, 4140 alloy steel and combinations thereof; the upper and lower bearings may be made of steel or stainless steel and combinations thereof; the upper and lower bushings may be made of steel, stainless steel, Phenolic resin laminate, glass filled nylon and combinations thereof; the middle bushing may be made of Torlon™ by Solvay Specialty Polymers, poly-vinylidene fluoride, glass filled Teflon™, Teflon™, low density polyethylene (LDPE), high density polyethylene (HDPE), ultra high

molecular weight (UHMW) Polyethylene, polypropylene, CE grade phenolic laminates, LE grade phenolic laminates, nylon and combinations thereof;

(66) As many changes can be made to the disclosure herein without departing from the scope thereof; it is intended that all matter contained herein be considered illustrative and not in a limiting sense.

Claims

1. A pneumatic motor for rotating an axle comprising: a. A housing comprising an air intake port; b. an air exhaust port; c. at least three cylinders; each cylinder being positioned radially from the axle; each cylinder being in a distinct cylinder radial plane from each other; d. at least two air channels in communication with each cylinder; e. at least three pistons, each piston attached to the axle by a connecting rod, each piston and respective connecting rod being radially aligned, in respect of the axle and in a distinct piston radial plane from each other, each piston to be received in one of said at least three cylinders; each connecting rod being attached centrally offset in relation to a central axis of said axle; and f. a modular bushing fit onto said axle to regulate communication of said air intake port and said air exhaust port with said at least two air channels in communication with each cylinder; wherein said modular bushing comprises a lower component, an intermediate component and an upper component, wherein each of said upper component and lower component further comprise a connecting collar receiving section to receive an end of a connecting collar axially connecting the upper component with the lower component forming a cylinder valve bushing for said pneumatic motor; wherein the lower component includes an upper area of a first diameter and a lower area of a second diameter allowing the connecting collar to be friction fitted within the upper and lower component, wherein the upper component and lower component are each cylinders, each having a same outer diameter and a same inner diameter relative to each other; wherein during a power stroke of one piston, said axle allows said air intake port to be in communication with the air channel in communication with one cylinder allowing air from the air intake port to enter into the cylinder; and during an exhaust stroke of one piston, said axle allows said air exhaust port to be in communication with the air channel in communication with said one cylinder allowing air to exit the cylinder through the air exhaust port; wherein when one connecting rod and piston are in power stroke, the other connecting rod and piston are in exhaust stroke and a third connecting rod and piston are in between an exhaust stroke and a power stroke.

2. The pneumatic motor of claim 1 further comprising at least three unitary piston cylinder caps, each cylinder cap forming a cylinder, on said pneumatic motor, each cylinder receiving a respective one of said at least three pistons.

3. The pneumatic motor of claim 1 further comprising at least three unitary piston cylinder caps, each cylinder cap forming a cylinder, on said pneumatic motor, each cylinder receiving a respective one of said at least three pistons, wherein each of said at least three unitary piston cylinder caps further comprise an cylinder cap air channel for communication with said air channel in communication with said cylinder of said pneumatic motor housing for exchange of air into and out of a space formed by each of said at least three pistons and each of said at least three unitary piston cylinder caps.

4. The pneumatic motor of claim 1 wherein one end of each of said connecting rods are stacked one atop another on said axle, in an axially offset configuration, resulting in each of said connecting rods and each of said pistons connected to said connecting rod being in a distinct radial plane, each distinct radial plane being parallel to each other.

5. The pneumatic motor of claim 1 wherein said upper component and lower component matingly engaged with each other by said intermediary component.

6. The pneumatic motor of claim 1 wherein said intermediary component is said connecting collar for connecting said upper component with said lower component.

7. The pneumatic motor of claim 1 wherein said upper component is a hollow cylinder having a top surface, a bottom surface, an outer collar surface and an inner collar surface, and wherein said upper component further comprises a plurality of air inlet and outlet channels, wherein said lower component further comprises at least one air intake channel running axially to said hollow cylinder, wherein said air inlet channels of said upper component are in fluid communication with said at least one air intake channel of said lower component when said air intake face of said axle is in line with said at least one air intake channel of said lower component, during rotation of said axle, wherein said air outlet channels of said upper component are in fluid communication with said air exhaust port when said air exhaust face of said axle is in line with said air outlet channels of said upper component, during rotation of said axle.
